

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1999-04-06

1 dear b ahá'í f riends,
2 and has asked us to respond as follows.
3 The house of justice is deeply concerned about the condition and needs
4 of the indigenous people . . . Although there is no doubt that increased ma-
5 terial resources would be helpful in resolving some of the problems which
6 exist there, they will not suffice to bring about a fundamental and enduring
7 solution. This can only come about through a realization that, at a basic level, the
issues which you face are essentially spiritual, dealing with values, attitudes, and behavior. h
ence, a spiritual solution is required.
8 The message of the bahá'í faith is that bahá'u'lláh has brought teach-
9 ings which are infused with a dynamic spiritual power with which the most
formidable barriers can be overcome and the most sweeping transformation
10 effected. you, dear friends, who have been privileged to accept these divine
11 teachings in this day can best meet your own needs and those of the wider
12 society . . . by giving first priority to your endeavors to put the bahá'í teach-
13 ings into practice. Through your obedience to bahá'í law, your striving to
14 spiritualize your lives, and your continuing effort to deepen your under-standing of
the holy writings, you can most appropriately respond to the 294.2
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295 3
296 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e
297 660needs of the present time. it is most important that you strive to make your
298 local Spiritual Assembly strong and effective, through its holding regular
299 meetings, its development of the skills of consultation, and through its at-
300 tention to pressing needs such as the holding of the Nineteen day feast, the

301 establishment of regular children's classes, and the provision of guidance to bahá'í
youth in their personal development and education.

302 As you persevere in such aims, you will find that your bahá'í community
303 will grow in unity and cohesion, and will attract the attention of those around you
because of its shining qualities. on such a foundation you will

be able to embark on a wide range of social and economic development

304 projects which will improve the material life of the people, and solve the
305 problems to which you have drawn attention in your letter. your Spiritual
306 Assembly should not hesitate to turn to your National Spiritual Assembly
307 for guidance in carrying out your functions, and should make every possible
308 effort to implement the directions it gives you. in addition, the Auxiliary
309 board members assigned to serve your area are a most valuable source of advice and
counsel.

310 you are assured of the prayers of the house of justice in the holy Shrines
311 on your behalf as you strive to carry out your duties.

312 with loving bahá'í greetings,

for Department of the secretariat

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Release of Compilation on Internal Opposition

to the Bahá'í Faith

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]